Klyara — Brand Guidelines

Extracted from klyara.com, not invented. Hand this to anyone who touches the brand.

Every value below is taken directly from the site's own CSS custom properties and its embedded font files. Where an earlier version of this pack said navy and safety orange, that was wrong and has been corrected throughout.

The line that matters

*Every value below is taken directly from the site's own CSS custom properties and its embedded font files.

In this part

Extracted from klyara.com, not invented. Hand this to anyone who touches the brand.

1. Colour

These are the site's :root tokens, verbatim. Use the token name in conversation, not the hex.

```
--paper    #F4EFE4   Warm bone. The page ground. Also called --bone.
--paper2   #ECE5D4   Deeper cream. Alternate rows, subtle blocks.
--card     #FBF8F0   Warm white. Cards and surfaces sitting on paper.
--ink      #14231C   Green-black. Primary text on paper.
--ink2     #22392E   Secondary dark.
--mute     #57685C   Muted sage. Body text that steps back, on paper.
--dim      #87947F   Dimmer sage. Muted text on pine.
--pine     #16352A   Deep green. Dark sections, covers, video, van livery.
--pine2    #1D4534   Lighter pine. Cards on pine, ghost numerals.
--em       #196A48   Emerald. Positive, "done", data bars, row labels.
--em2      #135237   Deeper emerald.
--brass    #C08A2E   THE accent. Rules, kickers, CTAs, numerals.
--warn     #A6592E   Terracotta. Warnings and negative data only.
```

Hairlines — the site uses translucent ink/bone. Flattened equivalents for print and images:

```
On paper:  #D6D0C2 (16%)   #B4AE9E (32%)
On pine:   #2A4A3C (16%)   #3E5D4E (32%)
```

How the colours actually behave

There are two grounds, and you pick one per asset. Paper (cream) or pine (deep green). Never a gradient between them, never a third ground.

Brass is the accent and it is used sparingly. The top rule, the kicker text, the numerals, the one thing you want clicked. It is not a background for body text and it is not a headline colour on paper — brass on cream fails contrast at small sizes.

Emerald is not a second accent. It means *positive, correct, complete*. Row labels in tables, "filed", data bars going the right way, the page number in the footer. If it is decorating rather than meaning something, it is wrong.

Terracotta is for bad news only. Penalties, missed deadlines, the losing side of a comparison chart. Never for emphasis.

Contrast, checked

TEXT	ON	VERDICT
--paper	--pine	Strong. The main dark combination.
--dim	--pine	Body text on pine

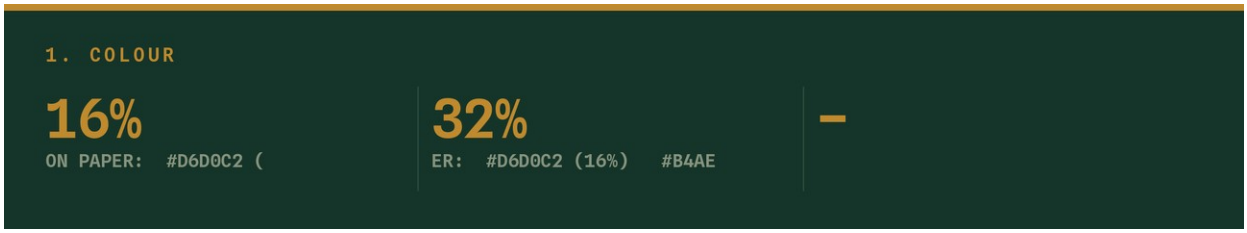
--ink	--paper / --card	Strong. The main light combination.
--mute	--paper	Body text on paper
--brass	--pine	Kickers, numerals, small bold
--em2	--paper	Table row labels, section leads
--brass	--paper	Large and bold only. Never body text, never small caps.
--pine2	--pine	Ghost numerals only — deliberately low contrast, decorative, never carries meaning
--em	--pine	❌ Too close. Use brass or paper on pine.

The line that matters

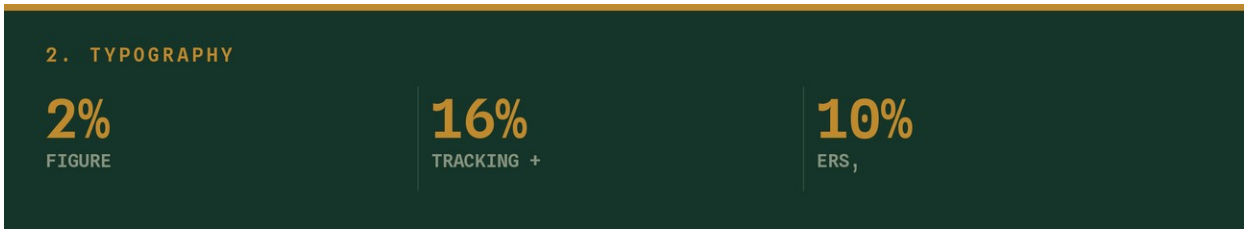
It is not a background for body text and it is not a headline colour on paper — brass on cream fails contrast at small sizes.

In this part

How the colours actually behave · Contrast, checked



2. Typography



Three faces, three jobs. All three are embedded in the site and included in this pack as static TTF instances at brand/fonts/.

```
Bricolage Grotesque   Display. Headlines, the wordmark, big numerals.
                      Weights used: 800 (display), 700, 600 (headings).
                      Tracking: -1.2% on headings. Optical size axis matters — the
                      600 cut is set at opsz 18, the display 800 at opsz 40.

Instrument Sans       Body. Everything you read in sentences.
                      Weights: 400 body, 500 emphasis, 650/700 labels.
                      Line height 1.66 on the web, ~1.5 in print.

Spline Sans Mono      Utility. Kickers, eyebrows, tags, chips, footers, dates,
                      page numbers, data labels.
                      Weight 500. ALWAYS uppercase. Tracking +16% on kickers,
                      +8–10% on footers and tags.
```

The kicker is the brand's signature

More than any colour, the thing that makes a piece of Klyara material recognisable is the **small uppercase brass mono label** sitting above a large Bricolage headline.

```
CHAPTER 02  ———
Are you a contractor?
```

Get that pairing right and almost everything else follows.

Headline rules

Headlines end with a full stop. "Run the jobs. We run the rest." "Are you in?" "MTD readiness checklist." "Verification." This is consistent across the whole site and all four PDFs. It is not optional styling — it is the voice.

Sentence case, never title case, never all caps. The only all-caps in the system are mono kickers and the KLYARA wordmark in print headers.

Scale — pick from the site's own clamps:

```
hero  2.7 → 5.6rem      h1  2.0 → 3.5rem      h2  1.45 → 2.05rem
h3    1.06 → 1.26rem    body 1.0 → 1.08rem    lede 1.1 → 1.3rem
```

Measure: the site sets .lede { max-width: 58ch }. Keep running text at 58–65 characters.

The font subset constraint — read this before making anything

The fonts embedded in the site are **subsets of 108 glyphs**. These characters do **not** exist and will render as blank gaps:

```
—  (em dash)     ✓ ✔  (ticks)      ✗ ✘  (crosses)     ⚠  (warning)     £
→  (arrow — absent from Spline Mono; present in the others)
```

Use instead: en dash –, the mid dot ·, drawn tick marks, and the word "and". Every generator in this pack routes text through a safe() function that substitutes automatically — if you write copy by hand into a design tool, do the substitution yourself.

The · mid dot is the brand's natural separator and it is present in all three faces. Use it.

The line that matters

Every generator in this pack routes text through a safe() function that substitutes automatically — if you write copy by hand into a design tool, do the substitution yourself.

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

The kicker is the brand's signature
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3. The mark

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

Two containers
Disc – a brass circle with the K in pine, sitting inside at 60% of the disc width. Used in print headers,

The wordmark
Two forms, both correct in their place:

Never
Minimum size: 24px on screen, 8mm in print. Below that, drop the disc and use the bare K. Clear space:

An angular **K** drawn as a single polygon, not a typeset letter. The exact coordinates, in an 88 × 88 box:

```
20,16  35,16  35,40  57,16  76,16  47.5,46  76,72  56,72  35,52  35,72  20,72
```

That polygon is the mark. Do not substitute a K from any typeface, including Bricolage.

Two containers

Disc — a brass circle with the K in pine, sitting inside at 60% of the disc width. Used in print headers, avatars, and anywhere the mark needs to hold its own.

Plain — the bare K in bone, no container. Used in the site header, where it sits on pine.

The wordmark

Two forms, both correct in their place:

- **Klyara** — sentence case, Bricolage 600. The web header, and anywhere the brand appears conversationally.
- **KLYARA** — all caps, Bricolage 800. Print headers and document covers only.

Mark-to-wordmark gap: 42% of the mark's height.

Never

- Retype the K in another font
- Recolour the disc away from brass
- Add a gradient, shadow, glow or outline
- Rotate, skew or stretch it
- Put it on a photograph without a solid ground behind it
- Write "KLYARA" in sentence-case contexts, or "Klyara" on a print cover

Minimum size: 24px on screen, 8mm in print. Below that, drop the disc and use the bare K. **Clear space:** 30% of the mark's width on all four sides.

The line that matters

Disc — a brass circle with the K in pine, sitting inside at 60% of the disc width.

In this part

Two containers · The wordmark · Never

4. Layout

AT A GLANCE

What is in this part

The two page architectures
Cover / full-bleed (pine). Brass rule across the very top. Wordmark and mono strapline top-left. A large a

Radii
One only: 0 26px 70px rgba(20,35,28,.14). Soft, large, low opacity, green-tinted. Never a hard drop shadow, ne

Shadow
One only: 0 26px 70px rgba(20,35,28,.14). Soft, large, low opacity, green-tinted. Never a hard drop shadow, ne

Components
"one-minute version" style summary block.

Margins

The two page architectures

Cover / full-bleed (pine). Brass rule across the very top. Wordmark and mono strapline top-left. A large amount of empty pine. Headline low on the page, roughly two-thirds down. Sub-headline in brass. Body in paper. Mono fine print at the bottom.

Interior (paper). A pine header band across the top, roughly 40mm on A4 or 17% of a social graphic. Inside the band: a mono brass kicker with a short brass dash rule, then the heading in paper, and a very large ghosted numeral in --pine2 bleeding off the right edge. A brass rule closes the band. Body sits on paper below. Mono footer, with the page number in emerald.

That ghosted numeral is doing a lot of work. Keep it.

Radii

```
--r     16px   cards, callouts, tables
--r-lg  24px   large panels
99px           pills, tags, chips
```

Shadow

One only: 0 26px 70px rgba(20,35,28,.14). Soft, large, low opacity, green-tinted. Never a hard drop shadow, never black.

Components

- **Pine callout** — deep green box, brass mono label, brass bullet dots, paper text. For the "one-minute version" style summary block.
- **Quote box** — card ground, emerald left bar 3px, brass mono label. For the aside that matters.
- **Brass box** — solid brass, ink text, for the single call to action at the end of a document.
- **Section head** — a 2.6px brass vertical bar to the left of a Bricolage 600 heading.
- **Table** — mono brass column headers, hairline under the header, hairlines between rows, emerald row labels in the first column. No vertical rules, no filled header block.

Margins

Social graphic	7.5% of width
A4 print	19mm
Web	--pad: clamp(20px, 4vw, 44px)
Max width	1240px

The line that matters

Inside the band: a mono brass kicker with a short brass dash rule, then the heading in paper, and a very large ghosted numeral in --pine2 bleeding off the right edge.

In this part

The two page architectures · Radii · Shadow · Components · Margins

5. Voice



Short sentences. Then a shorter one.

Headlines end with a full stop.

Specific over general. Not "significant penalties" — "£100 the day you're late, £200 at two months, £300 or 5% at six."

Second person. "You are in MTD." Not "clients in this position are within scope."

Say the uncomfortable thing. "You don't need the receptionist." "We're new and we're not going to pretend otherwise." "It is not fixable on 6 November." This is the most distinctive thing about how Klyara sounds and it is why it is trusted.

Lead with the reader's problem, never with Klyara.

Words to use

straight · sorted · handled · filed · on time · what it actually costs
the bit that catches people · gross means gross · plain English

Words never to use

solution · synergy · leverage (verb) · best-in-class · seamless · world-class
revolutionise · empower · "we're passionate about" · "unlock your potential"

Also banned: exclamation marks in marketing copy, emoji in email subject lines, and any sentence beginning "In today's fast-paced business environment".

Emoji

Functional and rare. 📅 for dates, 📌 for a deadline. Never decorative, never in a headline, never in a subject line. The site itself uses almost none — follow it.

The disclaimer — non-negotiable

Every piece of public tax content carries a version of the site's own line:

General guidance, not tax advice. Rules move — check gov.uk or ask us

General guidance, not tax advice. Rules move — check gov.uk or ask us before acting.

Keep it. You are publishing tax guidance under a bookkeeping firm's name.

The line that matters

"You don't need the receptionist." "We're new and we're not going to pretend otherwise." "It is not fixable on 6 November." This is the most distinctive thing about how Klyara sounds and it is why it is trusted.

6. Photography

Real over stock, always. The site's own imagery is real construction. A slightly badly-lit photo of an actual Guildford site beats a perfect stock image of models in clean hi-vis, and this audience can tell instantly.

Shoot: Craig at a desk with real paperwork. A phone photographing a crumpled receipt on a van dashboard. An actual site. Hands, tools, muddy boots, a laptop on a workbench.

Never: handshakes in front of glass buildings, diverse teams laughing at a whiteboard, rising-graph stock, immaculate unworn PPE.

Treatment: if a photo carries text, put a pine overlay at 70–85% behind the text block rather than dropping text onto the image.

The line that matters

A slightly badly-lit photo of an actual Guildford site beats a perfect stock image of models in clean hi-vis, and this audience can tell instantly.

Also worth knowing

Never: handshakes in front of glass buildings, diverse teams laughing at a whiteboard, rising-graph stock, immaculate unworn PPE.

7. Making new assets

Everything in this pack is generated from Python, and the generators ship with it. Use them rather than rebuilding by hand — it guarantees the tokens and the fonts are right.

```
brand/klyara_brand.py     Tokens, fonts, the K polygon, layout helpers, safe().
                          Change a colour here and every image rebuilds consistently.
brand/klyara_pdf.py       The print system for ReportLab — pine boxes, quote boxes,
                          brass boxes, tables, section heads, the mark.
brand/gen_identity.py     Logos, avatars, banners.
brand/gen_posts.py        Social posts, carousels, story covers, the deadline card.
brand/gen_video.py        Kinetic typography videos.
brand/gen_leadmagnet.py   The multi-page branded A4 guide.
brand/gen_proposal.py     Client proposals — edit the CLIENT dict, re-run.
brand/fonts/              The site's own fonts, converted to static TTF.
```

New social post: open gen_posts.py, copy a post(...) line, change the text, re-run. **New client proposal:** open gen_proposal.py, edit CLIENT, re-run. It names the file itself.

The line that matters

Use them rather than rebuilding by hand — it guarantees the tokens and the fonts are right.

Also worth knowing

New social post: open gen_posts.py, copy a post(...) line, change the text, re-run.

PROGRESS

Part 8 of 10 – 7. Making new assets 80%

How far through this document you are

8. Asset sizes

WHERE	SIZE	FOLDER
X header	1500×500	banners/
LinkedIn company	1128×191	banners/
LinkedIn personal	1584×396	banners/
Facebook cover	1640×856	banners/
YouTube channel	2560×1440	banners/
Reddit banner	1920×384	banners/
Google Business cover	1200×900	banners/klyara-banner-gbp.png
Email header	1200×260	banners/
Avatars	400 / 512 / 1024	avatars/
Square post	1080×1080	posts/
Carousel slide	1080×1350	carousel/
Story / highlight	1080×1920	stories/
Vertical video	1080×1920	video/
A5 print	1748×2480 @300dpi	print/

PROGRESS

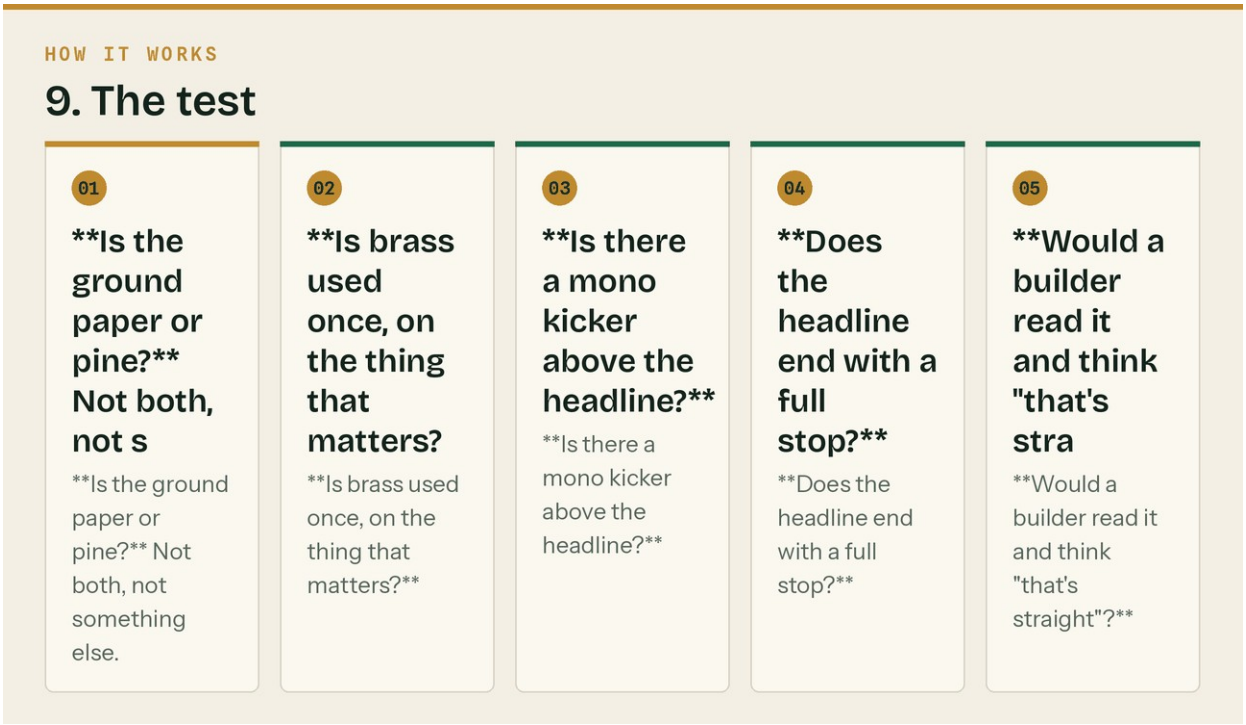
Part 9 of 10 – 8. Asset sizes 90%

How far through this document you are

9. The test

Before anything goes out:

1. **Is the ground paper or pine?** Not both, not something else.
2. **Is brass used once, on the thing that matters?**
3. **Is there a mono kicker above the headline?**
4. **Does the headline end with a full stop?**
5. **Would a builder read it and think "that's straight"?**



The same steps, in order.

If all five are yes, it's Klyara.

AT A GLANCE

The short version

Is the ground paper or pine? Not both, n

Is brass used once, on the thing that ma

Is there a mono kicker above the headlin

Does the headline end with a full stop?

Would a builder read it and think "that'